

Dendrolagus dorianus

Doria's tree kangaroo



Location New Guinea

Length 20–31 in
(51–78 cm)Tail 17½–26 in
(44–66 cm)Weight 14–32 lb
(6.5–14.5 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Vulnerable

rounded,
well-furred
muzzlefront limbs
almost as long
as rear limbs

Ten species of tree kangaroo occur chiefly across New Guinea and northeast Australia. They have short, broad, stout feet and long claws, for climbing through branches, using the long tail as a counterbalance. Unlike other kangaroos, the tree kangaroo can move each back leg independently. It spends most of its time in trees, moving relatively slowly but with great precision,

although it can walk and bound quickly on the ground. Doria's tree kangaroo is one of the largest and, like most other species in its genus, is mostly solitary and nocturnal, with a diet of various leaves, buds, flowers, and fruit. It has black ears, a whorled fur pattern in the middle of the back, and a pale brown or cream tail. After a gestation period of approximately 30 days, the single young attaches to the mother's teat in her pouch and suckles for up to 10 months. Like other tree kangaroos,

Doria's is dependent on a forest habitat and is therefore threatened by logging and other forms of forest clearance, as well as by hunting for its meat.

long,
dense,
brown furpadded,
roughened
soles on
rear feetnonprehensile
tail for balance*Macropus fuliginosus*

Western gray kangaroo



Location S. Australia

Length 26–87 in
(67–223 cm)Tail 16½–39 in
(42–100 cm)Weight 37–160 lb
(17–72 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



One of the largest, most abundant kangaroos, the western gray kangaroo has thick, coarse fur that varies from pale gray-brown to chocolate-brown, with a paler chest and belly. It lopes like a rabbit when moving slowly, using all 4 limbs, with the tail as a brace, but bounds on its back legs at high speed. Males are up to twice the size of females and can cover 33 ft (10 m) in one leap. This species grazes primarily at night, mainly on grasses, but it also browses on leafy shrubs and low trees. It lives in stable groups of up to 15. The dominant male is usually the only male to breed. The gestation period is 30–31 days.

powerful
tail

"BOXING" KANGAROOS



Male kangaroos battle for females during the mating season, and also for food or resting sites if these are limited. The antagonists lock arms and attempt to push each other over. They may also lean back on their tails and kick with the rear feet. As in most such contests, serious injury is rare.

JOEY ON BOARD

The young spends around 11 months in the pouch. From about 250 days, it begins to leave the pouch for short periods, but quickly returns if danger threatens.

Notamacropus parma

Parma wallaby



Location E. Australia

Length 18–21 in
(45–53 cm)Tail 16–21½ in
(41–54 cm)Weight 7¾–13 lb
(3.5–6 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Near threatened



The parma wallaby's distinguishing marks are a black stripe in the center of the red- or gray-brown fur on the back, from the neck to the middle of the back, and a white stripe on the side of the muzzle and cheek. Solitary, shy, and well camouflaged in dense vegetation, for a century it was believed to be extinct on the Australian mainland, but was rediscovered in 1967. This nighttime grazer and browser feeds on a very wide range of plants.

*Osphranter robustus*

Common wallaroo



Location Australia

Length 22½–43 ft
(57–109 m)Tail 21–35 in
(53–90 cm)Weight 62–130 lb
(28–60 kg)

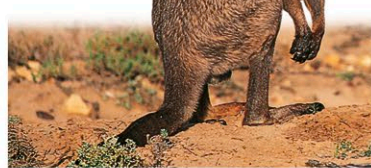
Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



Also called the euro or hill kangaroo, the common wallaroo is found in a range of habitats, but usually in and around rocky outcrops, cliffs, and boulder

piles. It shelters there by day, thereby surviving very hot, dry conditions, and by late afternoon moves out to forage on grasses, sedges, and other leafy foods. This wallaroo resembles other brown wallabies but may adopt a distinctive pose with shoulders back, elbows together, and wrists raised.

*Wallabia bicolor*

Swamp wallaby



Location E. Australia

Length 26–34 in
(66–85 cm)Tail 26–34 in
(66–85 cm)Weight 23–45 lb
(10.5–20.5 kg)

Social unit Individual

Status Least concern



Unlike other wallabies, this species moves with its head low and its tail held out straight behind. It has coarse, brown-black fur and a much darker

face, snout, front and back feet, and tail. Also called the stinker or black wallaby, it feeds at night on a wide diet of plant material, including toxic types such as hemlock.

*Tarsipes rostratus*

Honey possum



Location S.W. Australia

Length 2½–3½ in
(6.5–9 cm)Tail 2¾–4¼ in
(7–10.5 cm)Weight ¼–¾ oz
(7–16 g)

Social unit Group

Status Least concern



One of the smallest possums, this tiny, agile, nocturnal species has a long, pointed, well-whiskered snout and a long, prehensile tail. It lives in small groups, and its toes have soft, padlike tips and small, sharp claws, to grip both bark and glossy leaves. The 1-in (2.5-cm) long bristle-tipped tongue gathers pollen and nectar ("honey") from flowers, which are then scraped onto the much-reduced teeth (upper canines and lower incisors only).